05-09 第二篇

How Pets Improve Our Lives

Many people share their homes with cats, dogs, or other animals. These furry friends are more than just companions—they can actually make us healthier and happier. [1] In fact, studies have shown that people who own pets tend to have lower blood pressure and fewer visits to the doctor. Playing with a dog or stroking a cat can reduce stress and make us feel calm. Pets also encourage us to get outside and move around, which is good for both our bodies and our minds. That is why doctors sometimes suggest that patients consider getting a pet to improve their health.

Pets are especially good for children. [2] Taking care of a pet teaches kids about responsibility. They learn to feed their pet, clean its living space, and make sure it gets enough exercise. This sense of duty can help children do better in school and at home. Pets also provide comfort when children feel sad or worried. A dog that listens without judging or a cat that curls up on a child's lap can make a difficult day much easier. In other words, pets help children grow in both practical skills and emotional strength.

For elderly people, pets can be a lifeline. [3] Many older adults live alone and may feel lonely. A pet offers constant company and gives them a reason to get up each morning. Walking a dog forces them to go outside, meet neighbors, and stay active. Some studies even suggest that elderly pet owners are less likely to suffer from depression. For this reason, more and more nursing homes（养老院） are allowing residents to keep pets or bring in therapy animals for visits.

Of course, owning a pet is a big commitment. [4] Pets need food, exercise, regular check-ups at the vet（兽医）, and lots of love. Some people are not ready for this responsibility, or they may be allergic to animal fur. Before getting a pet, it is important to think carefully about whether you have the time, space, and resources to care for it properly. However, for those who are able to provide a good home, the rewards are often well worth the effort.

[5] In short, pets bring many benefits to people of all ages. They improve our physical health, teach us responsibility, and offer companionship when we need it most. If you are thinking about getting a pet, do your research first—and then get ready for a friend who will change your life for the better.

选项

A. That is because pets offer both physical and mental health benefits. B. In other words, pets help children develop important life skills and emotional support. C. That is why pets are increasingly seen as valuable companions for the elderly. D. It is true that pet

ownership requires time, money, and dedication. E. In conclusion, the benefits of having a pet often outweigh（超过） the challenges. F. For example, some pets can be trained to detect certain health problems.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：总领宠物对健康的好处。空前描述"These furry friends are more than just companions—they can actually make us healthier and happier"，空后列举"studies have shown...people who own pets tend to have lower blood pressure and fewer visits to the doctor...Playing with a dog or stroking a cat can reduce stress...encourage us to get outside and move around...doctors sometimes suggest that patients consider getting a pet"。A选项"That is because pets offer both physical and mental health benefits"（那是因为宠物同时带来身体和心理上的健康益处）中"That is because"解释空前"healthier and happier"，"physical and mental health benefits"与空后血压、就医次数、减压、户外活动等精准对应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：宠物对儿童的益处。空前提出"Pets are especially good for children"，空后详述"Taking care of a pet teaches kids about responsibility...feed their pet, clean its living space...sense of duty can help children do better in school...Pets also provide comfort when children feel sad or worried...pets help children grow in both practical skills and emotional strength"。B选项"In other words, pets help children develop important life skills and emotional support"（换言之，宠物帮助儿童培养重要的生活技能和情感支持）中"In other words"概括空后内容，"life skills"对应responsibility、duty，"emotional support"对应comfort、curl up on lap，与空后"practical skills and emotional strength"完美呼应，衔接自然。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：宠物对老年人的价值。空前提出"For elderly people, pets can be a lifeline"，空后描述"Many older adults live alone and may feel lonely...A pet offers constant company...reason to get up each morning...Walking a dog forces them to go outside, meet neighbors...elderly pet owners are less likely to suffer from depression...nursing homes are allowing residents to keep pets or bring in therapy animals"。C选项"That is why pets are increasingly seen as valuable companions for the elderly"（因此宠物越来越被视为老年人的宝贵伴侣）

中"That is why"承接空前"lifeline"，"valuable companions for the elderly"与空后company、reason to get up、therapy animals等形成呼应，衔接得当。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：养宠物的责任与考量。空前指出"Of course, owning a pet is a big commitment"，空后列举"Pets need food, exercise, regular check-ups at the vet, and lots of love...Some people are not ready...may be allergic...Before getting a pet, it is important to think carefully...whether you have the time, space, and resources...However, for those who are able...rewards are often well worth the effort"。D选项"It is true that pet ownership requires time, money, and dedication"（的确，养宠物需要时间、金钱和奉献）中"It is true that"与空前"Of course"呼应，"time, money, and dedication"与空后food、exercise、check-ups、love及time、space、resources完美对应，逻辑紧密。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：全文收束与建议。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"pets bring many benefits to people of all ages...improve our physical health, teach us responsibility, offer companionship...If you are thinking about getting a pet, do your research first"。E选项"In conclusion, the benefits of having a pet often outweigh the challenges"（总之，养宠物的好处往往 outweigh 挑战）用"In conclusion"总结全文，"benefits...outweigh the challenges"与空后"many benefits"及前文提到的commitment形成平衡，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, some pets can be trained to detect certain health problems.**：涉及宠物检测健康问题，易被误填[1]。但F以"For example"引出宠物作为医疗辅助的具体能力，而空[1]前后文讨论的是宠物对主人 general 健康的好处（降压、减压、鼓励运动），并未涉及"detect health problems"这类专业医疗功能；F属于服务犬、医疗犬等特殊用途，与空后"lower blood pressure...reduce stress...get outside"的日常健康益处层级不同。F属"主题相关但功能维度错位"型干扰。